

YDZ ENGLISH

TERM 2

WEEK 10

SIMPLE PAST OR PAST CONTINUOUS

Differences in Form

Simple Past	Past Continuous
irregular verbs: I woke up regular verbs: verb + ed I walked	past form of 'be' + ing form of verb I was walking you were walking he / she / it was walking we were walking they were walking
Exceptions when adding 'ed' :	Exceptions when adding 'ing' :
when the final letter is <i>e</i>, only add <i>d</i>. Example: love - loved<u>d</u> after a short, stressed vowel, the final consonant is doubled Example: admit - admitt<u>ed</u> after a consonant, final <i>y</i> becomes <i>i</i>. (but: not after a vowel) Example: worry - he worri<u>ed</u> but: play - he play<u>ed</u>	silent <i>e</i> is dropped (but: does not apply for <i>-ee</i>) Example: come – com<u>ing</u> after a short, stressed vowel, the final consonant is doubled Example: sit - sitt<u>ing</u> final <i>ie</i> becomes <i>y</i>. Example: lie - ly<u>ing</u>

Differences in use

After another or at the same time?

Do you want to express that the actions in the past happened one after another or at the same time?

Simple Past	Past Progressive
<i>after another</i> She entered the room, looked around and left angrily.	<i>at the same time</i> Mom was cooking dinner while dad was painting the door.

Only mentioning or emphasising progress?

Do you just want to mention that an action took place in the past (also used for short actions)? Or do you want to put emphasis on the progress, e.g. that an action was taking place at a certain time?

Simple Past	Past Progressive
<i>just mentioning</i> Linda worked out at the gym last night.	<i>emphasising progress</i> At 6 pm yesterday, Linda was working out in the gym.

EXERCISES

A. Join the sentences by using while and when.

1) I injured my elbow. I was playing tennis.

..... (when)

..... (while)

2) The students were making fun of their friend. The teacher entered the classroom.

..... (when)

..... (while)

3) Danny lost mobile phone. He was shopping in the mall.

..... (when)

..... (while)

4) Somebody stole my books. I was studying for the exam in the library.
..... (when)
..... (while)

5) My parents were getting ready to leave. The hurricane arrived.
..... (when)
..... (while)

B. Fill in the blanks with simple past or past continuous.

1. I _____ (listen) to music when Benjamin _____ (call).
2. When the phone _____ (ring), she _____ (cry).
3. While we _____ (play) outside, it _____ (start) to rain.
4. What _____ you _____ (do) when you _____ (hear) her voice after long years?
5. I _____ (listen) to music on my I-pod when I _____ (drop) it.
6. You _____ (not / listen) to me when I _____ (tell) you the news.
7. While Ross _____ (sleep) last night, someone _____ (steal) her laptop computer from his car.
8. Ted _____ (wait) for us when we _____ (arrive).
9. While I _____ (type) the letters, the computer _____ (break down).
10. A: What _____ you _____ (do) when you _____ (twist) your ankle?
B: I _____ (dance).
11. Last night at 4 PM, I _____ (talk) to my cousin on Skype.
12. At midnight, we _____ still _____ (walk) over the hills.

C. Complete the sentences with 'Past Simple' or 'Past Continuous' using the verbs in brackets

1. Mr. Thompson _____ (drive) very fast when he hit a tree.
2. Jack _____ (milk) the cows when a stranger came into the barn.
3. Susan _____ (see) the burglar while he was rushing into his car.
4. My uncle _____ (listen) to the radio when the earthquake happened.
5. The old lady was trying to cross the street when a boy _____ (offer) help.
6. All the children _____ (sleep) when their father opened the front door.
7. While Mr. Triumph _____ (fix) the television, he fell asleep.
8. Tina was playing with her dolls when her brother _____ (finish) his homework.
9. I was working on the Science project when you _____ (come) into the room with a big chocolate cake in your hand.
10. The children _____ (play) tennis when their grandmother called them for lunch.
11. Jack and Steven _____ (have dinner) when they heard a strange noise.
12. My brother was tidying the bookcase while I _____ (make) the beds.
13. What _____ (you do) when your father came home from work?
14. Who _____ (speak) while the teacher was introducing the new subject?
15. I suddenly _____ (fall down) while I was running away from the monster in my dream. I _____ (shout) when it caught my hand.
16. Mary _____ (look) out of the window when it started raining.